

Mataupu 16 / Chapter 16

Te 'Gana Nanumea / The Nanumean Language

Te 'Gana Nanumea (Tuvalu)	The Nanumean Language (English)
Te 'gana Nanumea he iloga tāua o tāgata Nanumea, he kope tāua 'kī. E fakaaogā e tātou a te 'gana Nanumea i pō takitahi, kae e mafai o galo ia tātou me he iloga tāua. I te lahiga o taimi, e hē manatua e tātou me i te tou 'gana he tahi o vaega tāua e mailoga ia ia tātou tino Nanumea. Me ko tulaga konā, e mafai ai te 'gana o galo atu fakatahi mo te mafulifuliga o te lalolagi.	The dialect of Nanumea is a rich heritage for us all – truly a cultural treasure. But although we use our language daily, we do not always remember that it is a treasure. We may also not realize that our language is an important part of our identity as Nanumeans, and that this language could even become lost as the world changes.
I tulaga o te lalolagi ite 21 senetenali tenei, a atufenua foliki e lahi te hē fakaaogāgina i faitu tau te atiakega o maumea, tulaga fakakautau, mo te mālosiga faka atufenua. I tauhaga takitahi, a 'gana totino e gaholoho'o ailoa o galo atu. E fia selau o 'gana hekeheke kolā ni fakaaogā i te 100 tauhaga koa olo atu nei, koa hē fakaaogā i te taimi nei. I te fia hoki o selau o 'gana kolā e aofia ai 'gana ote Pasifika, e tū nei i tulaga fakamataku.	In the post-colonial world of the 21st century, world capitalism and military and economic power easily dominate smaller nations. Whole languages disappear each year. Hundreds of the languages spoken in the world just 100 years ago are now extinct, and hundreds more, including many in the Pacific, are currently endangered.
Te fakamatakuga o te mafulifuliga o 'gana mo te gaholoholo o galo atu e tupu nei i Tuvalu. Kafai e pula tātou ki te Mālō o Tuvalu, e lahi te fakaaogā a te 'gana palagi. E fakaali mai ai me i te ukega o mea tāua i hokotakiga mo tuhituhiga i loto i te Mālō o Tuvalu e fai katoa i te 'gana palagi, kae hē ko te 'gana Tuvalu. E tokouke hoki a tino Tuvalu e palatahi e lātou mo muna palagi i loto i olotou taviliga fakatuvalu.	The process of language weakening and the danger of possible extinction can be seen right here in Tuvalu. For example, the official language of our government is English, which means most important government correspondence and publication is in English, not Tuvaluan. Many people also mix in English words when they are speaking or writing Tuvaluan.
E i ai hoki he mālosiga kia tātou ke tavili tātou ki te 'gana fakapogai Tuvalu, telā e mahani o lagona i te leo o Tuvalu, kae fakaaogāgina i Funafuti mo Vaitupu. I pō nei, te polokalame ko "Akoākoga mo te Olaga Saokatoa" telā e tokouke ai a tamaliki Nanumea mai te ākoga ko Kaumaile e olo atu o ākoga i Motufoua i Vaitupu. I Motufoua, a lātou e fakamalosigina a olotou tauhoa ke tavili ki te 'gana fakapogai Tuvalu.	In addition, there is pressure on us to speak a more "standard" version of Tuvaluan, the version heard most often on Radio Tuvalu and spoken in Funafuti and Vaitupu. With today's "Education for Life Program," most Nanumean children go on from the Kaumaile Primary school to Motufoua School in Vaitupu. At Motufoua, they are expected by their teachers (and by fellow students as well) to use the standard dialect.
Telā lā, mai te taimi koa 14 ia me 15 tauhaga te lahi o te tamaliki, te tokoukega koa pulatahi a 'gana manafai e tavili, e iai muna Nanumea e fakaaogā kae koa tavili ailoa pelā mo tino kolā e noho i te laumua. E penā hoki lātou kolā e noho i Funafuti, atu lā e hilia atu ite 700 (me ki luga ake) o tino Nanumea telā ko te mālosiga ailoa o te fenua. A 'tou tamaliki i konā e mafai o foliki ki	With the result that by the time they are 14 or 15 years old, most of Nanumea's young people speak a very mixed dialect, still using a few Nanumean words but sounding mainly like people in the capital. It is the same in Funafuti, where some 700 Nanumeans live and where our community is very active. Our children there may seldom hear and use Nanumean dialect in daily life.

te fakaaogā e lātou a te 'gana Nanumea i olotou tavilviliga i pō takitahi.	
A tino lahi hoki Nanumea kolā e noho i te laumua, e fakaaogā ailoa e lātou ate 'gana fakapogai Tuvalu. I lipōti ni fai mai, me e iai ni tulaga o tino gālue pelā mo lātou i loto i te sitoa, e hē maina i te 'gana Nanumea, koa ala ai a fakaaogā te 'gana fakapogai Tuvalu (mai fenuā). A tamaliki Nanumea hoki kolā e ola i atufenua i tua atu o Tuvalu, pelā mo Suva mo Aukilani, e foliki 'kī te olotou iloa i te 'gana Tuvalu, kae mailoga ailoa te 'gana Nanumea.	Even adult Nanumeans often switch to standard Tuvaluan while in the capital, reporting that otherwise store clerks may not understand them when they ask for items. Finally, our children growing up in overseas centres such as Suva and Auckland may know very little of the Tuvaluan language, and even less of their Nanumean dialect.
A te tou 'gana he iloga tafahili ite tāua kia tātou pelā hoki ki kautama gāholo o Nanumea. E fakapogai ki ai tou mailoga ite koe he tino Nanumea. Telā lā, e tau mo tātou o taumafai mālosi o fakatūmau me manafai koa galo. E mafai lā pehea e tātou o fakamautakitaki tou 'gana? E fesoasoani pehea tātou o fakahēai te fakalavelave tenei?	Our language lies at the core of Nanumean identity. Thus, it is of immense value to us and to the future generations of Nanumeans. What can we do to fight against its loss? How can we protect our unique dialect?
Ke fakamatamata tātou o tavili ki tou 'gana i mō mea ake e fano koe ki ai, i te ākoga i Vaitupu ia me ite laumua. Ke fakaakoako hoki tou gatama mo tou mokopuna ki te tāua o faifaiga faka-te-fenua, e aofia ai te 'tou 'gana. Ke fakamatamata tātou me koai tātou, kae ke fakaali atu mai te puke mau e tātou a te 'gana a 'tou tupuga.	By using it proudly, even when we go to school in Vaitupu, or live in the capital. By educating our children and grandchildren about the importance of our special cultural treasures, including our language. And by being proud of who we are, and showing it by keeping the language of our ancestors strong.
E iai he vaega toetoe i te kamataga o te tuhi tenei, e fakaholo ai a muna e uke kolā e fakaaogā tino Nanumea i pō nei, kae ni maua mai i fakamunamunaga a fenua o Tuvalu ki Saute, ia me mai Samoa. Mai te ukega o muna konei, e iai tinā muna Nanumea kolā e pau olotou uiga, kae konei ni fakaali atu, mo te mafaufauga me koa fakaaogā e tino Nanumea. Pelā mo te fakamunaga, "Fakaaogāgina ia me koa tiakinagina."	A short section at the start of this book provides a list of words and phrasings commonly used by Nanumeans today which are borrowings from the southern Tuvalu dialects, or from Samoan. For most of these words there are perfectly good Nanumean equivalents. Many unique Nanumean words still exist as well, but some of them have become archaic. As the saying goes: "Use it, or lose it!"
Fakamunamunaga Faka Nanumea	Nanumean Dialect Terms
Muna Nanumea / Uiga	Nanumean Word / Meaning
alolima <i>e lua uiga: 1) tālofa. Alolima ko te muna e māhani o fakaaogā kae fai e hepaki koe mo he tino. Tālofa he muna ni puke mai Samoa. 2) talia mo te fiafia; kau alolimagina koe; tali fiafia ki te koe. For opposite, see tuālima</i>	Two meanings: 1) tālofa (greeting). Alolima is the word commonly used when greeting someone. Tālofa is a word taken from Samoa. 2) To accept with joy; I welcome you; to respond joyfully to you. For opposite, see tuālima
fakalulu <i>fakaluaga (fakaala). "Tātou e fakalulu atafata."</i>	To rock/sway (fakaala). "We sway together."
fakaua	Families who are able to perform customary island duties as required by the island leaders.

<i>ni matakāiga kolā koa mafai e lātou o fai a tauliaga faka te fenua kolā e manakogina mai tino pulepule o te fenua.</i>	
fakautu <i>fānoanoa. "Tupu te fakalavelave, ka e noho koe mo te fakautu." "Te mea e tupu, kae fakautu."</i>	Sad, sadness. "When trouble arises, you sit with sadness." "Something happens, and there is sadness."
fekite <i>hepaki, fetau, "Lomiakoka, toe fekite."</i>	To meet again, reunite. "Goodbye, meet again."
fuaimone <i>tamiliki foliki, tamāfine mo tamatāne. Fakaaogā mo taohaga, penei: "Fuaimone muamua." Pula hoki ki mone</i>	Small children, girls and boys. Used for the young, e.g.: "The youngest child." See also mone.
fulihagafou <i>mahigale, mainaga (E fakaaogā ki te Pō o Tefolaha.)</i>	New dawn, a new beginning (used in the context of the Night of Tefolaha).
hāhā <i>tausi, leoleo, atafai</i>	To care for, watch over, look after.
haha <i>'tā katoa pulaka i te talo ke oti o kai</i>	To harvest all the pulaka taro until finished eating.
hapihapi <i>fakatokatoka. "Ke hapihapi koulua i te tāua e pili mai."</i>	To settle, arrange, prepare. "You two settle/prepare for the importance that approaches."
hau <i>muna a he tino, lauga i te āhiga. "Pelā mo te hau mai iko." Pula hoki ki pakū</i>	Words or speech of a person, utterance in the āhiga. "Like the speech from there." See also pakū.
hē motuhia <i>pau mo hē taumate. Atu lā</i>	Certain and without doubt. Absolutely.
huhu, huhuga <i>tāua, he tāua e fai</i>	Importance, a matter of significance.
hugo <i>fai valevale ou kope, hē fai faka 'lei mo kope; hē atafai. "A koe, koa oko ailoa i te hugo kope!"</i>	To treat one's things without respect, carelessly. "You always arrive treating things carelessly!"
kāleva <i>tagata mālosi, mau ki ivi. Strong, tireless, having great stamina. Comparison is to the kāleva bird: hard working, never tires, always at it.</i>	A strong, tireless person. Comparison to the kāleva bird: hard working, never tires, always at it.
kamiti <i>ke vave mai, fakavave mai, makini, makalo mai. "Kamiti mai!"</i>	Hurry up, hurry here. "Hurry up and come!"
kau malōmalō <i>mau ki ivi, mālosi. With regard to work, has lots of stamina, hard working.</i>	Hardworking, with great stamina. With regard to work, lots of endurance.
kolei <i>koe e toa</i>	You are brave/strong.

kopiti <i>matakāiga kolā koi fai fakatahitahi a olotou mea e fai. "I pō nei pelā me koa hēai ni faigamea fakakopiti koi lavea atu nei."</i>	Families who still do things together collectively. "Today it seems there are no more collective activities happening."
lāmutu <i>tuagane o te fafine ki te tama a te fafine tenā. I pō nei, koa lahi te fakaogaga o te muna tuātina ki te tama tenei; koa tai 'galo te muna lāmutu</i>	The brother of a woman to her daughter's child. Today, the word tuātina is commonly used for this person; the word lāmutu is nearly lost.
laumoti <i>sului. "Aumai ake tau laumoti!"</i>	Pandanus leaf cigarette. "Bring me your leaf cigarette!"
loloake <i>hepaki loloake. Fetau fakamuli</i>	To meet again at the end. A farewell greeting.
lomiakoka <i>tofā. Mai mua i te okoga mai o faifeau Samoa, e hē ai te muna tofā. Te fakatoetoega o lomiakoka ko "koka!"</i>	Goodbye (tofā). Before the arrival of Samoan missionaries, the word tofā did not exist. The response to lomiakoka is "koka!"
lotohano <i>loto māheī, kaihanohano (fāmeo, māsalosalo).</i>	Jealous, envious.
lototaumaheke <i>loto māheī, lotopikopiko. To dislike someone or not like them as well as someone else. Implies comparison. If there are two children, you may like one more than another; thus, you are lototaumaheke to the one you like less</i>	To dislike someone relative to another. Implies comparison — if there are two children, you may prefer one; thus you are lototaumaheke toward the one you like less.
maga <i>ni fakatelega o kāiga kolā e tele ailoa i luga o te toto. (pelā mo maga aliki)</i>	Branches of families with very strong bloodlines (e.g. the chiefly lineage branch).
mahavina <i>manino, maina, 'mā</i>	Clear, clean, pure.
mahigale <i>mainaga, mainaga fou, malamalama, fulihaga fou</i>	New beginning, new clarity, a fresh start.
'ma'mafa <i>vaega o meaalofo ki te fenua, e lafo mai he tagata. E hau mai te maumea o te fenua, pelā mo tona uluniu, ika etc. Afe a niu e taku pelā me ma'mafa</i>	A portion of gifts to the island, contributed by a person. The island's wealth comes in, such as coconuts, fish, etc. A thousand coconuts, for example, is called ma'mafa.
malo <i>loincloth. Man's garment, consisting of a long, finely woven mat (possibly made of hibiscus fau) wrapped around upper thighs and between legs</i>	Loincloth. A man's traditional garment — a long, finely woven mat (possibly of hibiscus fibre) wrapped around the upper thighs and between the legs.
mone <i>tama tagata foliki (me ko tamāfine hoki, me ikai?). Pula hoki ki fuaimone</i>	Small boy (possibly also girl?). See also fuaimone.
'moko <i>verb, to pair up with a "taina" partner through marriage (but of the opposite sex) for an event in the āhiga</i>	Verb: to pair up with a same-generation partner through marriage (opposite sex) for an event in the āhiga.

'mokoga <i>noun, a pairing up with a "taina" partner through marriage (but of the opposite sex) for an event in the āhiga</i>	Noun: the pairing up with a same-generation partner through marriage (opposite sex) for an event in the āhiga.
ou mata <i>tulou! Mai mua i te okoga mai o faifeau Samoa, e hē ai te muna tulou. Kae e fai penei: ou mata (tino toko tahi), ou lua mata (toko lua tino), otou mata ailoa (tino toko uke).</i>	Excuse me! Before the arrival of Samoan missionaries, the word tulou did not exist. Used as: ou mata (one person), ou lua mata (two people), otou mata ailoa (many people).
pakū <i>speech, utterance in āhiga. For example, this might be said by the Tukumuna of Nanumea at end of a short speech: "Tenā te pakū mai ikonei," me "Pelā mo te pakū mai iko."</i>	Speech or utterance in the āhiga. For example, said by the Tukumuna of Nanumea at the end of a speech: "That is the speech from here."
pakūkū <i>plural of pakū</i>	Plural of pakū (speeches/utterances).
pepeu <i>finau, tāua? Archaic, found in hymn by Vaelei (according to Siki).</i>	To argue, dispute? Archaic; found in a hymn by Vaelei (according to Siki).
poi mauili <i>be surprised. "E o'mai lātou mo 'lou pī, kae e poi o'lou mauili me e noho atu koulua mo tū pī." "E poi toku mauili!"</i>	To be surprised. "They came with your pig, and I was surprised you two stayed with a standing pig." "My heart was surprised!"
putaputa <i>pā fuefa, potopoto.</i>	Fat, chubby (describing a person).
putu lama <i>ko āvaga (faipoipoga) kolā ni maua i te Pō o Tefolaha, ko te fakatokaga o faiga o āvaga konei, e fai ailoa e te fenua.</i>	A marriage (wedding) that was formed on the Night of Tefolaha; the arrangement of these marriages is carried out by the island community as a whole.
taufakānoa <i>tamatāne koa oti ni katoa olotou 14-16 tauhaga</i>	A young man who has completed his 14–16 years of age.
tāuga <i>manuia, pāgatonu, taulafi</i>	Blessed, correct, well-positioned.
taulafi <i>e tai uiga tahi mo te muna tāuga</i>	Has the same meaning as tāuga.
tāumai <i>hau, fakavave mai, ou vae ke vave mai. "Tāumai ou vae!" "E Liki, tāumai!"</i>	Come quickly, hurry here, bring your feet quickly. "Hurry up!" "Hey Liki, come quickly!"
taumalo <i>kautama o tamaliki tāgata koa kātoa olotou taki 16 tauhaga, telā koa 'tau o 'ti a tona malo, me te ia koa kau ki loto i mea a tāgata.</i>	The coming-of-age ceremony for boys who have reached around 16 years, when it is time to put on his malo (loincloth), marking entry into adult male life.
tautiti <i>kautama o tamaliki fāfine koa kātoa olotou taki 16 tauhaga tēlā koa 'tau o lī olotou kautiti, me ite lātou koa 'lahi, koa 'kau ki loto i mea a fāfine.</i>	The coming-of-age ceremony for girls who have reached around 16 years, when it is time to put away their kautiti, signifying they have grown up and entered adult female life.
tīlāfenua	Sacred house, forbidden house.

<i>fale tapu, fale sā</i>	
tuālima <i>be angry at, displeased with. "Kau tuālima koe!"</i>	To be angry at, displeased with someone. "I am angry with you!"
tuātina <i>tama a te fafine ki te tuagane o te fafine tenā. E fakaaogā hoki i pō nei ki te tuagane o te fafine ki te tama a te fafine tenā. Kae i pō mua, e fakaigoa a te tama tenei ki te lāmutu, he muna e hē loko fakaaogā nei.</i>	A woman's child to her brother. Also used today for the brother of a woman to her child. In the past, this person was called lāmutu, a word no longer commonly used.
umeke <i>fakamakeke, taumafai malosi</i>	To persevere, strive hard, work with great effort.
umiti <i>fia kai 'kī ki ika</i>	To crave or greatly desire fish to eat.